

ANDELA × OPEN SOCIETY FOUNDATIONS · INVENTION SPRINT

Market*Trust*

Civic information people can find, verify, and act on — before they pay, click, or move.

Kenya first · English + Kiswahili · Working PoC

THE PROBLEM

WhatsApp forwards are not civic infrastructure.

Traders lose money to unofficial fees, fake KRA texts, and tender “awards” because verifiable answers are hard to find under pressure.

- Official portals exist — scattered, dense, easy to spoof
- “Agents” and rumours fill the gap with confident wrong advice
- No safe, simple path from doubt → verified next step → report

WHO IT'S FOR

The hustle economy — and those who protect it.

Traders & micro-businesses

Need to check permits, KRA, market fees, and scam texts before acting.

Small firms

Navigating county + national rules without paying middlemen.

Responders / CSOs

Need anonymous tips that arrive already labelled for triage.

Communities

Need rumour vs stamped notice — less panic, more cohesion.

THE SOLUTION

Find • Verify • Act

A WhatsApp-shaped assistant over a curated Kenya SME civic corpus — not an open-ended chatbot.

- **Ask** — answer + trust label + public sources + next steps
- **Report** — anonymous tip (privacy by default)
- **Cases** — human triage handoff after intake

WHY NOT CHATGPT?

Fluency is not trust.

General AI chat

Optimises for a confident answer. Can invent fees, portals, or refund steps. No civic reporting loop.

MarketTrust

Constrained corpus. Unmatched → **Unclear**.
Sources + next steps. Anonymous Report → Cases.
No API key for the PoC.

DEMO MOMENT

One SMS. Two very different answers.

"I got a KRA text — is it real?"

VERIFIED · SUSPICIOUS KRA SMS

Don't click the link. Open iTax yourself. Screenshot and report. — Not the generic "how to get a PIN" article.

Same product also answers "Do I need a KRA PIN?" correctly — intent-aware retrieval, not keyword coincidence.

HACKATHON TRACKS

Cross-track on purpose.

Transparency

Permits, taxes, official fees —
with sources you can open.

Safety

KRA / tender / M-Pesa scams +
anonymous reporting
pathways.

Stability

Rumour vs stamped county
notice; less friction, clearer
truth.

REAL-WORLD CONDITIONS

Built for how people decide under pressure.

- **Trust & verification** — labels, sources, reviewed dates; Unclear when unmatched
- **Low bandwidth** — static SPA; offline Ask from in-bundle corpus
- **Accessibility** — plain-language mode, skip link, keyboard UI
- **Privacy** — tips stay on-device for the PoC; anonymous by default
- **Multilingual** — EN + SW now; FR / AR / PT + local languages on the path
- **Local relevance + next steps** — Kenya seed; checklists + Report escalation

UNIQUENESS & SCALABILITY

Not another chatbot — a trust shell.

Unique

Unclear is first-class. Intent-aware civic corpus + anonymous Report→Cases separates fluency from verification.

Scalable

Swap locale corpus packs (laws, institutions, languages) — keep the same labels, next steps, and escalation shell across OSF geographies.

POTENTIAL IMPACT

Fewer costly clicks. Better tips for partners.

- Traders verify before paying “agents,” fake KRA links, or tender fees
- Partners receive labelled, anonymous tips ready for triage
- Path to WhatsApp — where hustle-economy advice already lives

AI coding tools accelerated the build; the core find/verify/act idea is original to this capstone.

WHY DEVELOP FURTHER

From PoC to WhatsApp pilots.

Next: Meta Cloud delivery, deeper maintained corpus, trader-association / CSO case routing. Invention sprint today — civic infrastructure tomorrow.

MARKETTRUST — VERIFY BEFORE YOU ACT.